

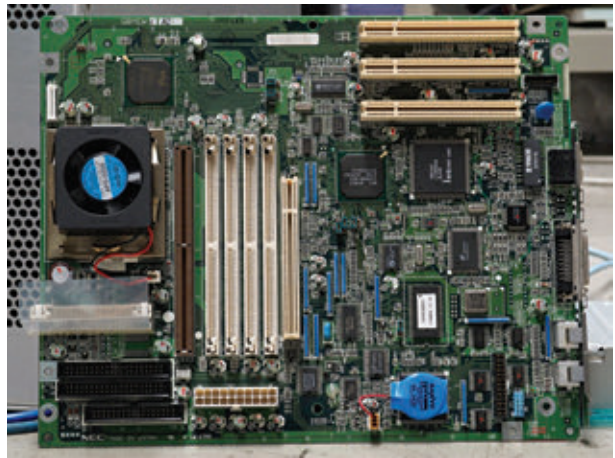
technician, many employers prefer or require applicants to have an associate or bachelor's degree. Pursuing a degree in computer-related fields such as computer hardware technology, computer repair technology, information technology, information science, computer science, computing and security, or engineering can help you acquire in-depth knowledge and skills in the field, making you stand out among other candidates.

3. **Sharpen your skills:** Computer repair technicians can acquire technical skills through their education, work experience, or self-study. Some start by examining their own computer hardware and troubleshooting common problems for family and friends. You can develop your computer repair skills by studying computers, hardware, and networks through online groups, courses, and books.
4. **Get professional experience:** Professional experience plays a significant role in advancing the skills of computer repair technicians and qualifying them for higher roles. Individuals can gain professional experience by applying for entry-level positions that involve computer technology. Some may start their careers by working in customer service or help centers in various industries. For instance, an aspiring computer technician may work at a university help desk and assist with technical inquiries in the library.
5. **Explore certifications:** IT professionals have the option of obtaining certifications to demonstrate their industry knowledge and technical skills. While certifications may not be required for computer repair positions, some roles may mandate specific certifications. Certifications are available in general IT or special software programs. When selecting a certificate program, it's important to consider your skills, interests, and job preferences.
6. **Apply for relevant roles:** Computer repair technicians have the option to work in various locations such as repair centers, businesses, healthcare organizations, schools, or as freelancers. Before applying for a position, it is important to consider your preferences. To apply for jobs, develop a resume and cover letter that highlights your hard and soft skills. IT professionals should list their specific software knowledge and certifications on their resumes to demonstrate their qualifications. For those interested in freelancing, reach out to network connections or potential clients to find opportunities.

### What skills are needed?

Computer repair technicians utilize a range of hard and soft skills to excel in their profession. Below are some significant career skills they can apply:

1. **Customer service:** A lot of computer technicians work directly with customers and clients. They listen to customers' computer issues, provide training on new software and educate others on the best computer practices. They can employ



strong customer service skills such as empathy and patience to help them accomplish these tasks.

2. **Active listening:** Active listening is an important skill for computer repair technicians to have as it enables them to fully understand a customer's computer issues. With active listening, technicians can quickly troubleshoot and resolve issues.
3. **Proper Communication:** Computer repair technicians may need to communicate complex technical concepts to clients and customers. They may also conduct software training within a company or explain processes to residential customers. Strong verbal communication skills are essential to expressing ideas clearly to different audiences.
4. **Problem solving and analytical skills:** Computer repair technicians utilize problem-solving skills to effectively troubleshoot and resolve computer issues. They also employ analytical thinking to evaluate and diagnose technical problems, analyzing how a computer operates to develop a solution.
5. **Technical Skills:** Technical skills and industry knowledge are also essential for computer technicians, who may need expertise in computer programming, coding, hardware repair, or network analysis, and proficiency with various software programs and computer languages.

### What is the scope of work?

A computer repair technician is responsible for ensuring that computer systems operate correctly. Their specific duties may vary depending on their work environment and position, but common responsibilities include:

1. Setting up new computer systems
2. Installing software and computer programs
3. Maintaining and troubleshooting existing software
4. Updating and verifying computer security programs
5. Instructing customers on best security practices
6. Analyzing computer functions and repairing hardware or servers as necessary